The JianZiPu font uses a **glyph layering system** where each musical notation character is built by combining multiple component glyphs that stack and position themselves relative to each other. So each character is made of a series of glyphs, similar to how an English word is made of a series of letters.

> **Why the spacebar is essential:** Each space character acts as a *positioning anchor* that tells the font where to place the next set of layered components. Without spaces, the glyph components would overlap or misalign, resulting in unreadable notation. The spacebar essentially advances the "cursor" to the next character position, ensuring proper spacing and alignment of the layered musical symbols.

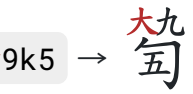
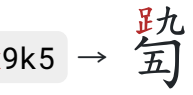
> **Sibelius/MuseScore Users:** In these music notation programs, the "space" advances lyrics to the next note. If you are using JianZiPu as lyrics, this messes up with formatting. In this case use `+` after a character to give the character some width. Ex: `勾七+` or `k7+` will display correctly in these programs as  , then use spacebar to advance to the next note. `：泛起+名九挑六` or `:fanqi+s9u6` will be processed as one word  in these programs and thus both these will be attached to one note.

---

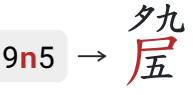
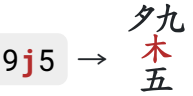
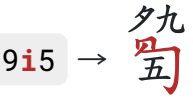
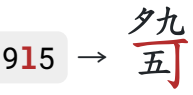
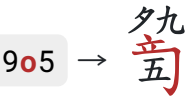
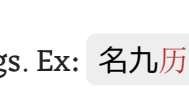
1. Basic Layout

For left hand...

- `名` or `s` → Ex: `名九勾五` or `s9k5` → 
- `中` or `d` → Ex: `中九勾五` or `d9k5` → 
- `食` or `f` → Ex: `食九勾五` or `f9k5` → 

- 大 or v → 大 Ex: 大九勾五 or v9k5 → 
- 跪 or x → 𧾷 Ex: 跪九勾五 or x9k5 → 

For right hand...

- 劈 or n → 尸 Ex: 名九劈五 or s9n5 → 
- 托 or h → 乇 Ex: 名九托五 or s9h5 → 
- 抹 or j → 木 Ex: 名九抹五 or s9j5 → 
- 挑 or u → 𠂉 Ex: 名九挑五 or s9u5 → 
- 勾 or k → 勹 Ex: 名九勾五 or s9k5 → 
- 剔 or i → 𠙵 Ex: 名九剔五 or s9i5 → 
- 打 or l → 丁 Ex: 名九打五 or s9l5 → 
- 摘 or o → 亠 Ex: 名九摘五 or s9o5 → 
- 历 or U → 厂 This takes two strings. Ex: 名九历五四 or s9U54 → 

For numbers in hui position and string... well, just use numbers! Which numbers? Like 五 or 5. You can also use 外 or 13+ for the 卜 character, as well as 散 and 0 for the 艹 character.

- 名九勾五 or s9k5 →
- 名外勾五 or s13+k5 →

- `散勾五` or `0k5` → 

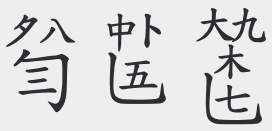
> **Note!** Mixing and matching (e.g., `勾3` or `k三`) is not always supported, the text might render on Chrome but not in Word.

Try it out below! Type in the box and the notation underneath follows as you type.

Type here to preview text

名八勾三 中外挑五 大九抹挑七

See example in 中文 or **ASCII**



---

2. Numbers and Decimals

If you are using ASCII, you can note a decimal by just writing 7.5, 7.6, etc.

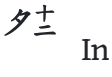
If you are using Chinese, the font will treat the numbers different depending on if they are preceded by a left hand glyph or not. For example, if two numbers are follows a left hand, then that gets converted to decimals (s76 => s7.6), can put comma between (s7,6)

- `名七六` and `s76` → 7.6 hui (no string) 
- `名七,六` and `s7,6` → 7 hui, string 6 
- `名七六六` and `s766` → 7.6 hui, string 6 
- `名十一` and `s10.1` → 10.1 hui (no string) 

- `历七六` and `U76` → string 7, string 6  Here 76 is not converted into 7.6 since it's not preceded by a left hand glyph

For Chinese, you can also use 点 and 徽 to indicate decimals For example, `名七点九` gives  .

Here are some crazy examples:

- `名十` gives 
- `名十二` gives  In the code this is represented as 10.2
- `名十二徽` gives  In the code this is represented as 12, though I don't know if visually it's all that different from 10.2 above.
- `名十，二` gives 
- `名十二二` gives 
- `名十二二二` gives 

Anything that results in ".5" hui will be rendered with the character.

- `中八半勾五` gives 
- `中八五勾五` also gives 
- `d8.5k5` also also gives 
- `d85k5` also also also gives  Do you see the difference? There's no period between 8 and 5, but the font still treats it as a decimal.

Anything that's after the 13th hui will be rendered with the character. You can use `13+` or `外` for the character.

- `名外挑六` and `s13+u6` gives 
- `名十三二挑六` and `s132u6` gives 

You can use `散` or `0` to indicate an open string as in `0k5` or `散勾五` → 

You can use `就` or `jiu` to indicate a repeat from the previous character as in `jiuk5` or `就勾五` → 

Type here to preview text

`名七五 名七，五 名七五五 名七徽五 名7.5 名十二`

See example in 中文 or **ASCII**



---

3. Basic Modifiers

There are a lot of modifiers in the font, but there a few that is positioned in funny places around a JianZiPu character. I'll show it with a  character

- `泛音名九勾六` or `fys9k6` → 
- `名九急勾六` or `s9>k6` → 
- `名九绰勾六` or `s9/k6` → 
- `名九注勾六` or `s9\k6` → 

- `名九绰注勾六` or `s9/\k6` → 

Type here to preview text

泛音名九勾六

See example in 中文 or **ASCII**



---

4. Chords

For the purpose of the font, a chord is anything where there's something on the left and right side, and generally takes up more space.

Ex:  or  or 

You start with a "chord" indicator, `撮` or `C`, and use the `|` to separate the left and right side.

- `撮大九，六丨散三` or `Cv9,6|03` →  Note you'll need to use a comma between the hui and the string, otherwise...
- `撮大九六丨散三` or `Cv96|03` →  .. you get this. And yes, the system is smart enough not to interpret 03 as 0.3.

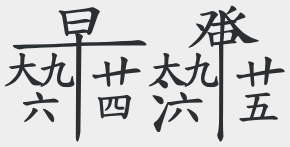
You can see the complete list of chords in the glossary below.

Here's a few "chords" for you to try out.

Type here to preview text

撮大九，六丨散四　拨剌大九注六丨散五

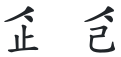
See example in 中文 or **ASCII**



---

5. Vertical Texts

Vertical texts are just a string of characters, and will be rendered vertically. You start with a vertical indicator, `：`. While the characters here have ASCII equivalents, you should probably use Chinese characters to avoid ambiguity with homonym pinyins. Also in general, it is more robust with Chinese characters.

- `：上七九` or `:shang79` → 
- `：下六二` or `:xia62` → 
- `：分开` or `:fenkai` →  this is actually one character I squished together.
- `：泛止 ：泛起` or `:fanzhi :fanqi` → 
- `：滚沸` or `:gunfu` → 

Please reference the glossary below for the complete list. There are quite a bit.

You can also embed some left handed glyphs with hui positions.

- `：大八五轮七` or `:v8.5lun7` → 
- `：大八五七` or `:v8.57` → 

- `：大八五` or `:v8.5` →  Note that `八五` is interpreted as 8.5
- `：大八,五` or `:v8,5` →  If you don't want `八五` to be interpreted as 8.5, then you can use a comma `八，五`

Here are some examples to try out.

Type here to preview text

`：上六四 ：下七九 ：滚沸 ：泛止 ：泛起 ：名九，`

See example in 中文 or **ASCII**



---

6. Glossary

Keyboard Map (Basic Glyphs)
Open the keyboard map (a picture of a computer keyboard, best on a big screen)

1: Left Hand

1a: Left Hand Finger

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
1	s	名	míng	 名九勾三 s9k3
2	d	中	zhōng	 中九勾三

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
				d9k3
3	f	食	shí	 食九勾三 f9k3
4	v	大	dà	 大九勾三 v9k3
5	x	跪	guì	 跪五四勾三 x5.4k3

1b: Speed Mods & Mods Related To 韵 Production

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
6	/	绰, 綽	chuò	 名九绰勾三 名九綽勾三 s9/k3
7	>	急	jí	 名九急勾三 s9>k3
8	\	注, 註	zhù	 名九注勾三 名九註勾三 s9\k3

1c: Left Hand Techniques

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
9	V	掩	yǎn	 名九掩六 s9V6

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
10	c	掐起	qiā qǐ	 名八掐起 s8c
11	fanyin, fy	泛音	fànyīn	 泛音名九挑六 fanyins9u6 fys9u6

1d: Special Cases

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
12	0	散	sàn	 散勾五 0k5
13	jiu	就	jiù	 就勾五 jiuk5

For use in Vertical Layout only

preface these with `:` and best use Chinese characters to avoid ambiguity with homonym pinyins

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
14	:daiqi	:带起	dài qǐ	
15	:duiqi	:对起	duì qǐ	
16	:zhuaqi	:抓起	zhuā qǐ	
17	:pieqi	:撇起	piē qǐ	

1e: Left Hand Vibratos And Slides

For use in Vertical Layout only

preface these with `:` and best use Chinese characters to avoid ambiguity with homonym pinyins

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
18	:tui	:退	tuì	艮
19	:jin	:进, :進	jìn	隹
20	:fu4	:復	fù	旬
21	:zhuang	:撞	zhuàng	立
22	:yin	:吟	yín	ラ
23	:nao	:猱	náo	犭
24	:zhangyin	:长吟	zhǎng yín	長ラ
25	:xi4yin	:细吟	xì yín	細ラ
26	:dingyin	:定吟	dìng yín	亼ラ
27	:xiaoyin	:小吟	xiǎo yín	小ラ
28	:fenkai	:分开, :分開	fēnkāi	幵

2: Right Hand

2a: Basic Right Hand

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage

29	:yinghe	:应合, :應合	yīng hé	庆
30	:tang	:淌		尚
31	n	劈	pī	 散劈五 0n5
32	h	托	tuō	 散托五 0h5
33	j	抹	mǒ	 散抹五 0j5
34	u	挑	tiāo	 散挑五 0u5
35	k	勾	gōu	 散勾五 0k5
36	i	剔	tī	 散剔五 0i5
37	l	打	dǎ	 散打五 0l5
38	o	摘	zhāi	 散摘五 0o5

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
39	ju	抹挑	mǒ tiāo	 散抹挑五 0ju5
40	ki	勾剔	gōu tī	 散勾剔五 0ki5
41	lo	打摘	dǎ zhāi	 散打摘五 0lo5
42	U	历, 歷	lì	 散历六五 散歷六五 0U65

2b: Chords

These notes are written with strings noted on the right and left. Preface the character with the chord key, and then separate the right v. left with a `|`.

ex: `Cs9,3|05` or `撮名九,三|散五` will make 

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
43	C	撮	cuō	 撮中八，七|散五 Cd8,7|05
44	DC	大撮	dà cuō	 大撮中八，七|散二 DCd8,7|02
45	FC	反撮	fǎn cuō	

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Usage
				反撮中八，七 | 散二 FCd8,7|02
46	B	拨, 撥	bō	 拨中七，七 | 散六 撥中七，七 | 散六 Bd7,7|06
47	L	剌	là	 剌中七，七 | 散六 Ld7,7|06
48	BL	拨剌, 撥剌	bō là	 拨剌中七，七 | 散六 撥剌中七，七 | 散六 BLd7,7|06
49	TT	双弹, 雙彈	shuāng dàn	 双弹中七，七 | 散六 雙彈中七，七 | 散六 TTd7,7|06
50	TTT	三弹, 三彈	sān dàn	 三弹中七，七 | 散六 三彈中七，七 | 散六 TTTd7,7|06

2c: Other Right Hand Strum Techniques

For use in Vertical Layout only

preface these with `:` and best use Chinese characters to avoid ambiguity with homonym pinyins

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
51	:lun	:轮, :輪	lún	
52	:banlun, :bl	:半轮, :半輪	bàn lún	
53	:dayuan	:打圆, :打圓	dǎ yuán	
54	:gun	:滚, :滾	gǔn	
55	:fu	:沸	fèi	
56	:beisuo	:背璅	bèi suǒ	
57	:duansuo	:短璅	duǎn suǒ	
58	:zhangsuo	:长璅	zhǎng suǒ	
59	:diejuan, :dj	:叠鐲, :疊鐲	dié juān	
60	:yanlou, :yl	:圆搂, :圓摟	yuán lǒu	
61	:banfu, :bf	:半扶	bàn fú	
62	:quanfu, :qf	:全扶	quán fú	

3. General Symbols (Vertical Layout Only)

Preface with ： to write the character by itself. Best use Chinese characters to avoid ambiguity with homonym pinyins.

3a: Related to Score: TBD

3b: Related to Notes

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
63	:fan	:泛	fàn	
64	:zhi	:止	zhì	
65	:qi	:起	qǐ	
66	:fanqi	:泛起	fàn qǐ	
67	:fanzhi	:泛止	fàn zhì	
68	:ru	:如	rú	

3c: Related to String & Hui Number

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
69	:1..:13	:一..:十三		
70	:wai, :13+	:外	wài	
71	:0, :san	:散	sàn	
72	:ban	:半	bàn	
73	:jiu	:就	jiù	

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
74	:shang	:上	shàng	上
75	:xia	:下	xià	下
76	:zhi4	:至	zhì	厶

3d: related to position： TBD

3e: related to expression

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
77	:vxi	:大息	dà xī	太自
78	:shaoxi	:少息	shǎo xī	少自

Placeholder for Future/Unknown Characters

ID	ASCII	中文	拼音	Output
79	:*			☒